QUICK CARDS

30 CARDS

David Silva

PHOTOGRAPHY

Car Meet Quick Cards

Angles, light and settings for the day. One situation per card. Swipe to the one you need.

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The Car Meet Field Guide explains the why.

The day plan

- 0:00 walk the venue, arrivals
- 0:20 heroes before the crowd
- 1:00 details and signatures
- 1:30 the venue, rows
- 2:15 owners and stories
- Last 30 min departures



Ten hero frames

- 6 cars: front and rear 3/4
- a signature, a venue wide
- an arrival, one more
- 4 people: owner and car
- a conversation, hands, crowd



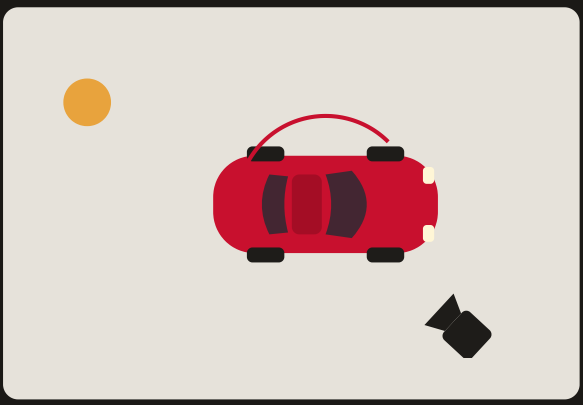
Overcast

- Expose for the car
- +0.3 to +0.7 EV, car fills frame
- Sky thin: go low or high
- Polariser on paint and glass
- ISO 400 to 800, WB Cloudy



Hard sun

- Find shade for whole cars
- Half light, half shadow
- Polariser at 90° to the sun
- Details and shadows
- Heroes later, in softer light



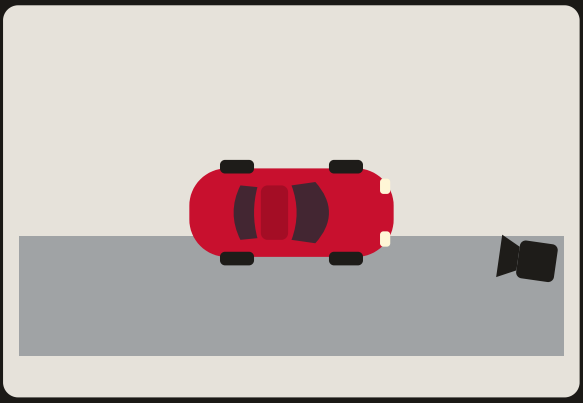
Low sun

- Sun to the side: shape
- Backlight: glowing edges
- Hide the sun behind the car
- Use the long shadows
- Drivers are dazzled: stand clear



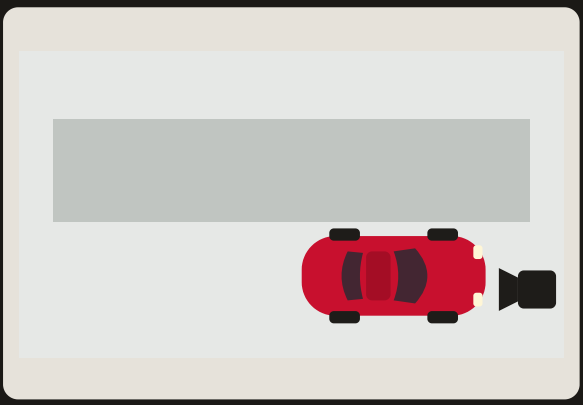
Rain

- Go low for reflections
- Beading: close, f/1.8 to f/2.8
- Raise ISO, keep 1/125 s
- Umbrellas and people
- Hood on, cloth ready



Fog and frost

- Be early: it burns off
- Car close, background far
- +1 EV, +2 if backlit
- Focus on a badge or a light
- Bag the camera before going in



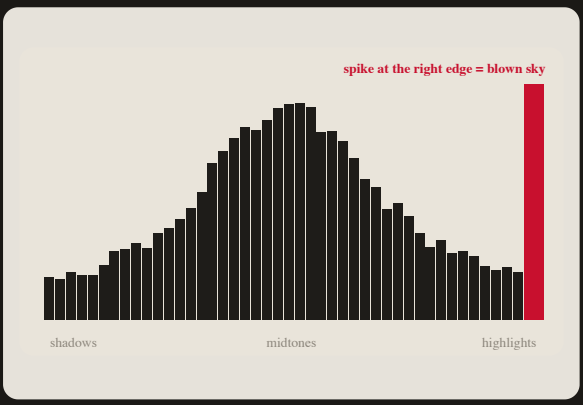
Dusk

- Lights on: ask the owner
- Expose for sky and lights
- Brace, 1/60 s or faster
- Trails: tripod, 10 to 30 s
- Watch blown headlights



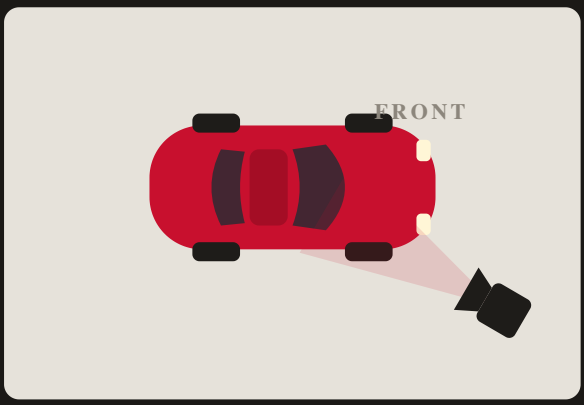
Check in 5 seconds

- Blinkies and RGB histogram on
- Paint blinking: -0.3 EV
- Sky blinking only: fine
- Red car: check the red channel
- Tarmac fills frame: +0.3 EV



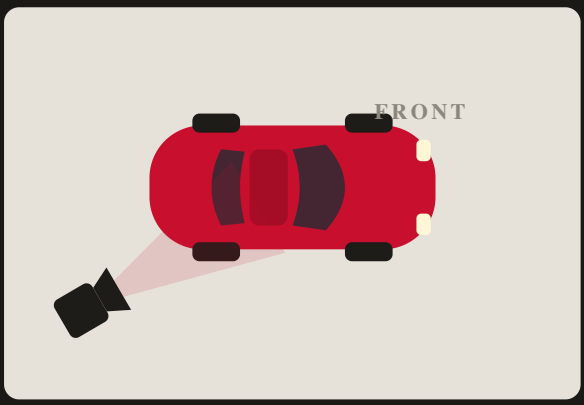
Front three-quarter

- 30 to 45° off the nose
- Two car lengths back
- Headlight height or lower
- Wheel face to the camera
- f/5.6, ISO 400, +0.3



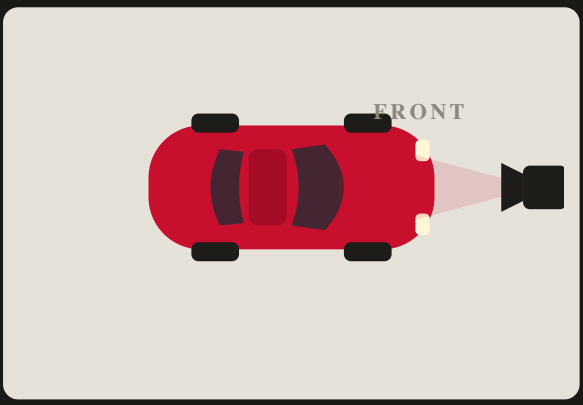
Rear three-quarter

- 30 to 45° off a rear corner
- Tail-light height
- Haunches, light bar
- Crouch for a wing
- Mind the plate



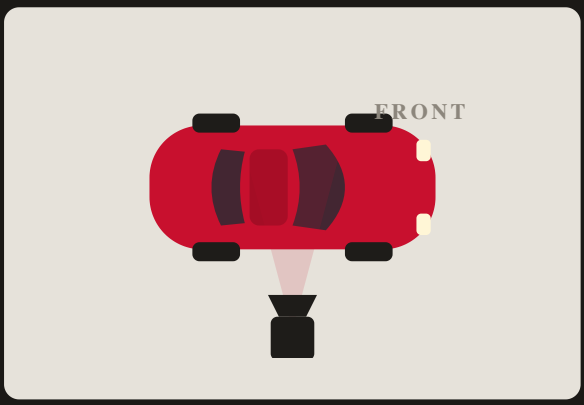
Low front

- Lens at bumper height
- Tarmac, not sky, behind
- Step back, don't go wider
- Tilt screen, kneel
- +0.3 EV for tarmac



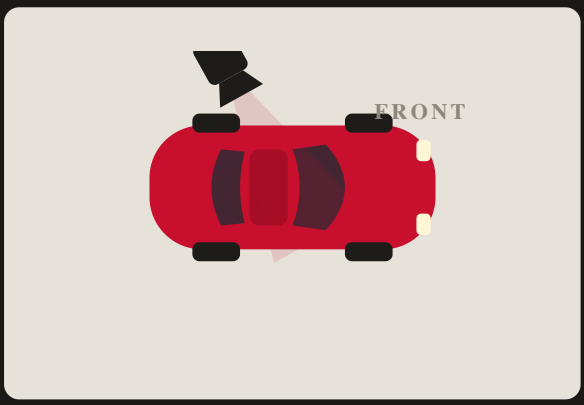
Side profile

- Square to the centre
- Far back, crop later
- Door-handle height
- Roofline stays true
- Dark background, not sky



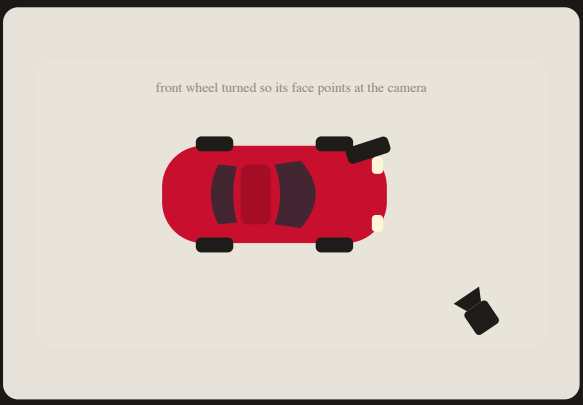
Head-on and high

- Head-on: badge centred
- Headlights level
- High: arms up, tilt screen
- Tarmac as background
- Square crop suits head-on



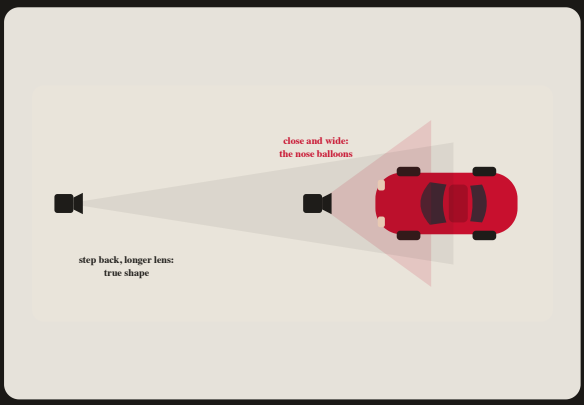
Wheels and distance

- Wheels 15 to 20° to camera
- Steering centred inside
- Crest upright in the cap
- Closer than 2 lengths? Too wide
- Owner moves the car



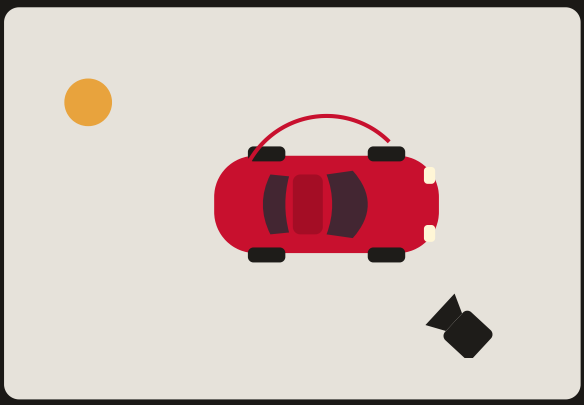
Background first

- Walk round the car first
- Pick the cleanest side
- No poles from the roof
- Hide bins and cones behind it
- Busy? Go low or go close



Positioning a car

- Light first: side light
- Part light, part shadow
- Wheels 15 to 20° to camera
- Far from the background
- Dark clothes: you reflect



Scouting

- Street View: surface, background
- Sun app: where and when
- Clear Outside: cloud, fog
- Room to step back
- Whose land? Ask



Badges and wheels

- f/2.8 to f/4, slightly off axis
- Focus on the lettering
- Polariser on chrome
- Wheels at hub height
- Caliper through the spokes



Interiors

- Ask before doors or leaning in
- Through the window or door
- Raise ISO inside
- Polariser through glass
- Wheel centred, dials square



Marque signatures

- Roofline: true profile, far back
- Light bar: straight rear, lights on
- Crests on bonnet and wheels
- Wing: crouch, break the skyline
- Old and new down one row



Camera defaults

- Statics: A, f/5.6, polariser
- Busy street: S, 1/800 s+
- Details: A, f/2.8 to f/4
- People: f/2 to f/2.8, 1/250 s
- Auto ISO, max 3200



Handheld

- Elbows in, eye to finder
- Breathe out, squeeze
- Brace on a wall, never a car
- Burst of 3: keep the middle
- 35 mm: 1/40 s, or 1/10 s with IS



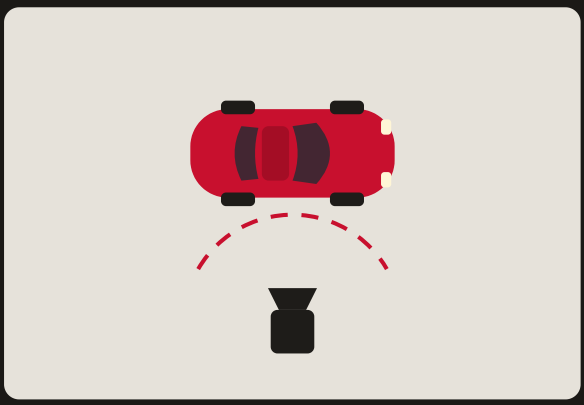
On a phone

- Main camera, not ultra wide
- Hold to lock focus and exposure
- Slide down for bright skies
- ProRAW for the edit
- Slide shutter left for burst



Panning

- S mode, start 1/125 s
- Then 1/60 s, 1/30 s
- Continuous AF, burst
- Turn from the hips, follow through
- Stand back from the lane



Photograph the people

- Talk first, shoot second
- Stay where a crowd gathers
- Candid: step back, wait
- One with the owner, if happy
- Offer to send the photos



The ready line

- "Lovely car."
- "I'm photographing the meet."
- "Mind if I take a few frames?"
- "Maybe one of you with it?"
- No? Smile and walk on



Etiquette

- Never touch without asking
- Mind bags, straps, zips
- Don't walk through shots
- Children: faces out
- Send the photos afterwards



Plates and privacy

- Blur plates before posting
- Unless the owner says otherwise
- No names in captions
- Private land: owner's terms
- Drones never over a crowd



Before you post

- Pick about ten frames
- No cut heads, no cut limbs
- Straighten everything
- Blur plates
- Export 1080 x 1350 (4:5)



The full guide and the newsletter

- The Car Meet Field Guide: the why behind every card
- Planning pages: print them, fill them in
- The newsletter: what I'm learning, as I go
- No spam, unsubscribe any time
- Join: https://davidslv.photography/field-guide/

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